



Remember

- Complete [this form](#) if you have not been **allocated to a team**
- If you are **unable to access the GitLab repository**
 - Please log on to <https://projects.cs.nott.ac.uk>
 - **Azure MFA**
 - Use your **UNUK** e-mail address
- Signup starts 01/10/2025
 - **Only team admins** can sign up
 - **Teams for which there is evidence of bots will be deprioritised**





**University of
Nottingham**

UK | CHINA | MALAYSIA

COMP2002 - GRP CV & Example

Dan Marsden (Coordinator)

Katie Bonner (Careers & Employability)



University of
Nottingham

UK | CHINA | MALAYSIA

Katie Bonner

Careers Advisor (Careers & Employability)



University of
Nottingham
UK | CHINA | MALAYSIA

Building a quality application

Katie Bonner – Careers Adviser



What we're covering

- Building blocks of a good application,
- Why doing group project work is great experience to include in your applications

Strong evidence: Action + Specifics + Purpose + Contribution

Name and contact detail
Personal profile
Education (Projects, modules, technical skills)
Relevant experience
Other experience
Interest or extracurricular activities

Technical
Team
Client
Project

Keep the receipt
Situation: What was happening
Contribution: What did you actively do
Result: What happened / what did it enable
Learning: What would you repeat or change

Five Checks:
Target
Evidence
Priority
Clarity
Accuracy



Your turn: Build one piece of evidence

Choose **ONE** experience:

- University programming/project work
- Part-time work
- Personal coding project
- Society, sport or volunteering
- Hackathon/Game Jam
- Something else you've done

Solely responsible for the backend development of a web application using Java and MySQL, implementing RESTful APIs, business logic, and database integration to support frontend functionality and data management.

Use these prompts if you get stuck:

What did I do?

What did I use?

What was it for?

What did I contribute, produce or solve?

Now write ONE CV bullet using:

4 mins. Write, don't just think

Action + Specifics + Purpose + Contribution



The recruitment process

Pre-application
tests

CV/cover letter
and/or
Application Form

Psychometric
Tests

Telephone
and/or Video
Interview

Assessment
Centre and/or
Interview

Offer



What is the employer looking for?

Job ads come in all shapes and sizes.

- Look for key words:
- Tasks, duties or responsibilities,
- Named skills,
- Essential criteria and desirable criteria,
- Any key values they describe?

Other sources:

- the employer's homepage
- Job profiles e.g., [Prospects' job profiles](#)



Key Ingredients for any application:

- Structure
- Presentation
- Evidence
- Relevance





Good applications have this in common:

- They persuade and inform an employer about your abilities, experiences and motivations to show you're a good fit for their role,
- They provide evidence to show you meet the requirements described in the job description and person specification,
- They describe why you are applying for the role and organisation and demonstrate wider research on the opportunity,
- They have clear presentation, structure and layout with no spelling mistakes.



Your application building blocks



Year 2 group projects marking criteria

- This shows you what to include
- Read the instructions
- Tailor your evidence to the project

Curriculum Vitae	CVs are marked by the supervisor once teams are assigned to projects.	Criteria: 1. The CV was submitted in the correct format 2. Contact details provided and appropriate 3. Education details and grades are included 4. CV uses reverse chronological order 5. A consistent format was used 6. Language/style are professional written 7. Evidence of tailoring CV to a particular project 8. Relevant experience (technical/expertise) 9. Soft transferable skills and/or extra-curricular activities 10. CV has appropriate length and content
	Total:	
Expression of Interest	Motivation (20%)	Criteria: - Motivation / interest for the project - Motivation / understanding of sponsor's needs - Matching of team skills / interests to project
	Understanding of the brief and context (20%)	Criteria: - Understanding of the brief - Analysis and understanding of the wider context - Analysis and understanding of existing projects
	Preliminary Analysis (30%)	Criteria: - Discussion of applicable tools / libraries - Proposed initial approach and motivation - Identification of challenges and issues
	Management (20%)	Criteria: - Project management approach discussed - Preliminary / high level project plan - Identification of challenges / skills gaps
	Style (10%)	Criteria: - Formatting / structure - Language / grammar / spelling
Total:		



Your CV – what should it include?

- Name and contact details
- Personal profile (optional)
- Education/Qualifications
- Employment history/Work experience
- Skills profile (optional)
- Interests & Achievements (optional)

YOUR NAME

email | Phone number |

SUMMARY

Give a brief introduction to yourself and the type of work experience you're looking for.

Focus on your top two or three skills.

EDUCATION

Your University and Degree course

Date - expected finish

- Summary overview of what your course is designed to teach you,
- Relevant module and knowledge,
- Key project and skills used

Your old secondary school name

date - date

A level: Outline your subjects and grades in one sentence

GCSE: Outline your optional subjects and grades in one sentence

- English grade
- Maths grade

RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

A part-time job / volunteer experience

date - date

a brief description to set the scene

- a task you completed
- a skill you developed
- a result

A relevant course project

date - date

a brief description to set the scene

- a task you completed
- a skill you developed
- a result

A hobby or extra-curricular activity

date - date

a brief description to set the scene

- a task you completed
- a skill you developed
- a result



Suggested section order for Y2 group projects

01 Education

- Put education and qualifications before experience
- Most recent first,
- Include your marks

02 Relevant Experience

- Your most relevant experience should be on your first page
- Think about the transferable skills (teamwork, communication)
- Include your technical skills

03 Other Experience

- Less detail needed, but show transferable skills,
- May include outside interests, part-time work, society or sport involvement,



What counts as relevant experience?

- Anything that provides evidence of:
 - Team skills
 - Technical skills
 - Project / time management

This could come from modules, part-time work, volunteering, clubs/society involvement, university projects, individual projects etc.



To help you prepare: Introducing CAR(L)

- **Context:** Briefly describe the context of your experience
- **Action:** Explain what actions you took
- **Results:** Explain what happened because of your actions
- **(Learning):** Identify what you have learned

Other reflective frameworks include:

- [STAR](#)
- [What? So what? Now what?](#)
- [The 5R framework](#)





Demonstrating what skills we have in an expression of interest

- Think of something you've done recently, write down a short outline of what happened
- Write down the top three skills you've used or learnt from that experience
- What does this experience say about you? How does this match the project you're interested in?

My experience	Top three skills	This shows
I joined a hackathon in first year to develop an IoT-based solution to reduce food waste. I worked with 2 others on the project and developed mini-milestones to keep us on task during the challenge. I was nervous that I might not have all the programming skills needed, but I learnt from my team and we ended up with great feedback from the judges.	I learnt that I had a good foundation knowledge of programming and that I have good ideas. Using mini-milestones helped me manage my time and I learnt that not everyone uses time effectively. I was able to stay calm under pressure and still had fun.	This experience shows I am committed to a team and can be successful in a challenging situation by putting in milestones to keep us on track. I would take a similar role with this project and put myself forward for the chance to stretch my coding skills



Key things to note

- A CV can go up to 2 sides of A4
- Photos, date of birth, marital status etc., are **not** needed on UK CVs
- Use a consistent format across section headings, dates, job titles etc.,
- Use a typeface that is easy to read (like Gill Sans, Ariel or Open Sans)
- Link your past experience and skills to the new project – show your interest and motivation as well as your technical ability.
- The CV is the factual snapshot, the expression of interest brings your experience to life with description
- Check spelling and grammar before submission
- <https://careerset.com/nottingham> - get your CV and expression of interest checked



Further resources and support

- Our “[Get employers to take notice of your CV](#)” and “[How to write the perfect covering letter](#)” sections on [Begin!](#), our e-guide to careers
- The University’s Making Applications [CES webpages](#)
- How to build an effective CV and covering letter [short course](#)
- How to write an effective application form [short course](#)

[Blog](#): How to use your studies to demonstrate skills in an Application



Why group project work is needed



Employability skills

- Employers are looking for a range of skills in their employees,
- Working with others is a big part of every role,
- Enthusiasm and motivation to keep learning is often more important than specific technical skills.
- Showing how you apply your skills in real world scenarios.





Teamwork and client work is challenging

- “Our client talked...a lot. Each meeting went on for ages with no real point to it and they kept changing their mind each meeting.”
- “One member of the team was a real waste of time. They didn’t contribute anything and left the rest of us to pick up their tasks.”
- “What the client wanted was too ambitious in the timeframe. We didn’t know how to tell them we wouldn’t be able to deliver it all.”
- “I hated the project from the beginning, as it didn't interest me.”
- “My team was a nightmare; they argued all the time, so I ended up doing all the work.”



Navigating teamwork

Tuckman's team
development
model





Think about what role you play in a team

Belbin's Team Roles Model

The nine roles are grouped into 3 Categories





The experience you gain

It's worth it in the end

- Communicating professionally with external clients – how much, how often, how?
- Understanding client requirements,
- How to gather and understand project specifications,
- Teamwork (and certain challenges with teamwork),
- Leadership and project management,
- Professionalism,
- Commercial awareness,
- Overcoming real life problems and challenges,
- And some coding too!



What's your next step going to be?

Good luck with your project!



Meet the team

Here to support with:

- Discussing future ideas,
- Making decisions,
- Signposting to resources,
- Interview preparation,
- CV, cover letters and applications





What do we do? Appointments

- 1:1 appointments between 20 – 30 minutes,
- Available in person or online throughout the working week including university holidays,
- A confidential space to talk through ideas, plans or tasks,
- Guide you towards your next step,
- Not just CV checks (although we do offer that!)

[Log into MyCareer to see available appointments](#)





Career Essentials Programme

Boost your career confidence with our weekly sessions!

Why join?

- Practice in a safe environment with support from career experts.
- Learn key strategies for success in your career journey.
- Attend online or in-person sessions to suit your schedule.

[Explore workshops and sign-up via MyCareer](#)



Online "how to..." sessions:

- How to stand out with work experience
- How to get part-time work
- How to prepare for interviews
- How to write a personal statement
- How to get the most from a careers event
- How to decide if further study is right for me
- How to create an all-star LinkedIn profile
- How to create CVs and applications

In-person interactive sessions:

- Assessment centre practice (virtual & in-person)
- Interview practice
- Using AI in applications
- Identifying your strengths



Module Structure

Semester 1

Project Signup

Competitive Bidding

Project Allocation

Development 1

CV

Proof of Concept

Interim Report

Interim Peer
Assessment

Semester 2

Development 2

Final Product

Demo Day

Repos

Group Reports

Final Peer
Assessment

Individual
Report



- **Project sign-up 01/10 – 03/10**
 - Project can be selected once (**FCFS**)
 - Only the **team admin** can sign up to projects
 - Any challenges, please let me know
 - When signed up, you are **allowed to bid**
- **Registration:**
 - In 2023, 678 views by 09:00 on the first day
 - Some projects typically very **popular**
- **Students were assigned to projects in the past**
 - There was no **bidding / signup**
 - Some **choice** now



- An **expression of interest** consists of:
 - Your CVs
 - A written expression of interest ([template](#), [rubric](#))
 - A 10-minute pitch video
- The **pitches** consist of:
 - The pitch video
 - 10 – 20 minute **Q&A session** on MS Teams
- **Team admin:** use specified file naming conventions



- Optimised **project allocation** based on:
 - Sponsor and team **preferences**
 - 49 teams - 6 scores per team - 294 in total
 - The **average team rank** across all pitches
 - **Priority** weighting
 - Optimised using **MILP** (CPLEX)
- Allocated by 24/10/2025 – 27/10/2025



Assessment - Components

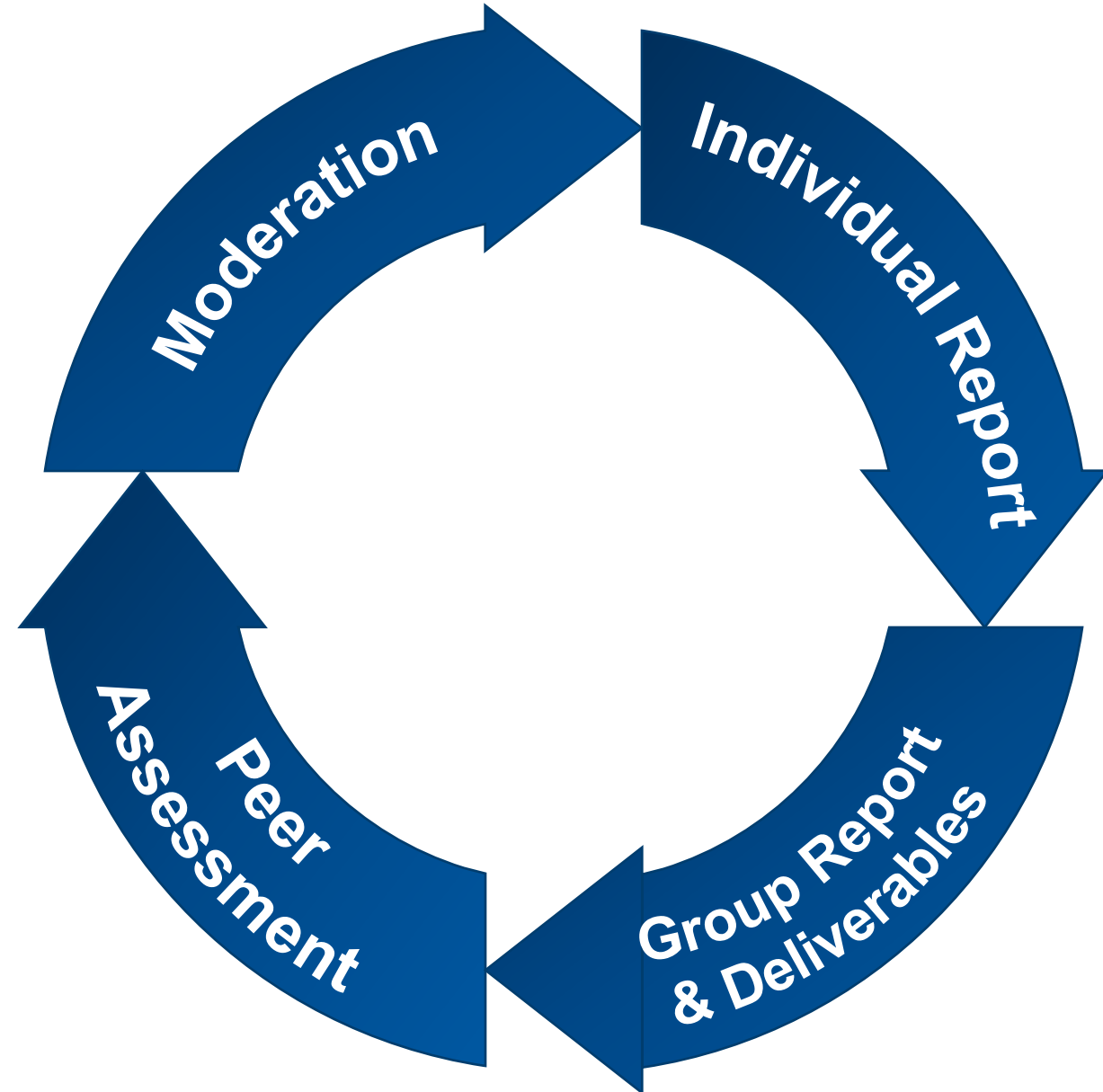
Group Deliverable	Component Contribution	Overall Contribution
Eol & Pitch	15%	12%
Interim Report & Prototype	10%	8%
Interim Peer Assessment	-	-
Group Report	25%	20%
Stand / Demo / Presentation	15%	12%
Software / Project Management	35%	28%

Individual Deliverable	Component Contribution	Overall Contribution
CV	20%	4%
Peer Assessment	20%	4%
Individual Report	60%	12%



Assessment - Scaling

- Assessment considers:
 - **Group elements** (80%)
 - **Individual elements** (20%)
- **Group elements are scaled** based on:
 - Individual reports
 - Group deliverables (e.g. document and code repositories)
 - Peer assessment (deviation from average)
 - Supervisor moderation





Assessment – Peer Review

Instructions:

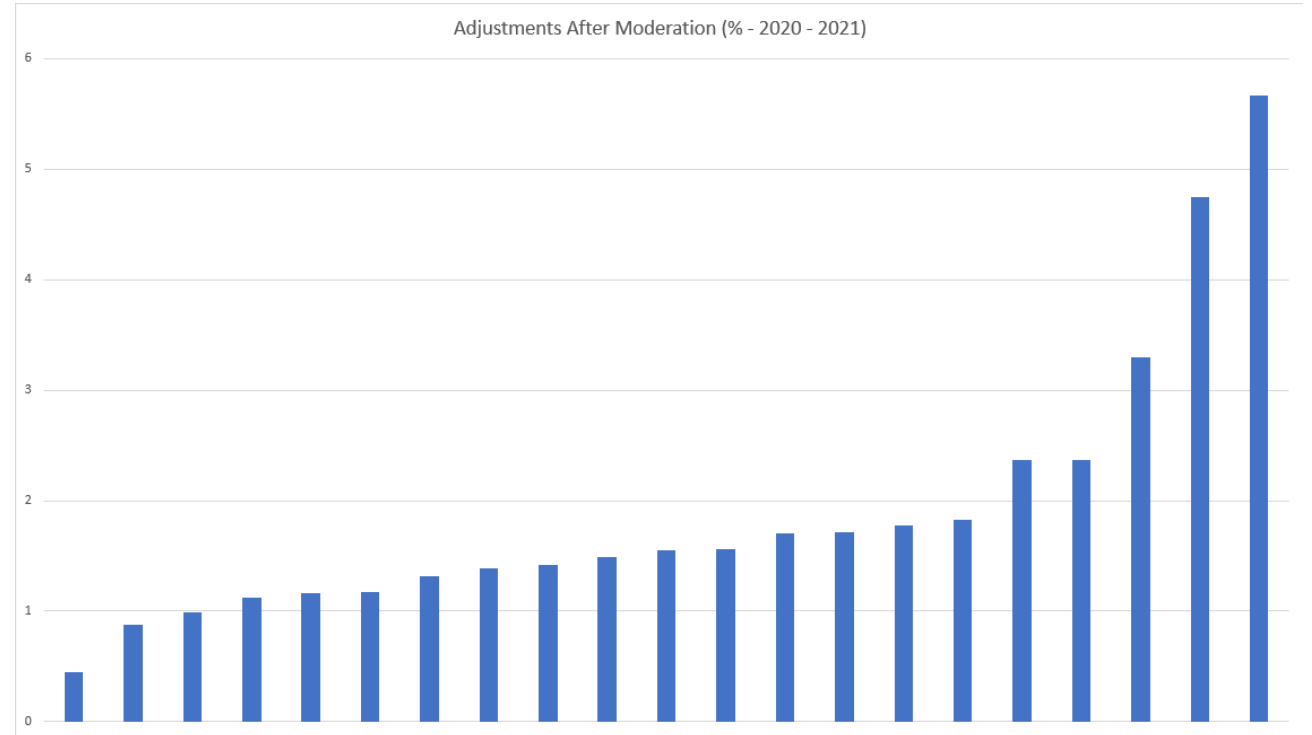
- Do not change the filename when submitting it.
- Do not provide peer review scores for yourself.
- Please enter a score between 1 and 5 in the evaluation column for each category. 1 is very poor, 5 is outstanding.
- Please provide a motivation for your score for each of the categories.
- Please leave cells blank for member that have not participated in the module.

<u>Team Number</u>	<u>Last Name</u>	<u>First Name</u>	<u>Username</u>	<u>Category</u>	<u>Evaluation</u>	<u>Motivation</u>
1	Bullock	Nikhil	psynb3	General Contribution to the project		
				Attendance at meetings		
				Creativity		
				Work rate		
				How did they perform as a team member		
1	HUANG	Jou-Yin	scyjh2	General Contribution to the project		
				Attendance at meetings		
				Creativity		
				Work rate		
				How did they perform as a team member		
1	Taylor	Lucy	psylt4	General Contribution to the project		
				Attendance at meetings		
				Creativity		
				Work rate		
				How did they perform as a team member		
1	LI	Rongze	scyrl1	General Contribution to the project		
				Attendance at meetings		
				Creativity		
				Work rate		
				How did they perform as a team member		



Mark Moderation

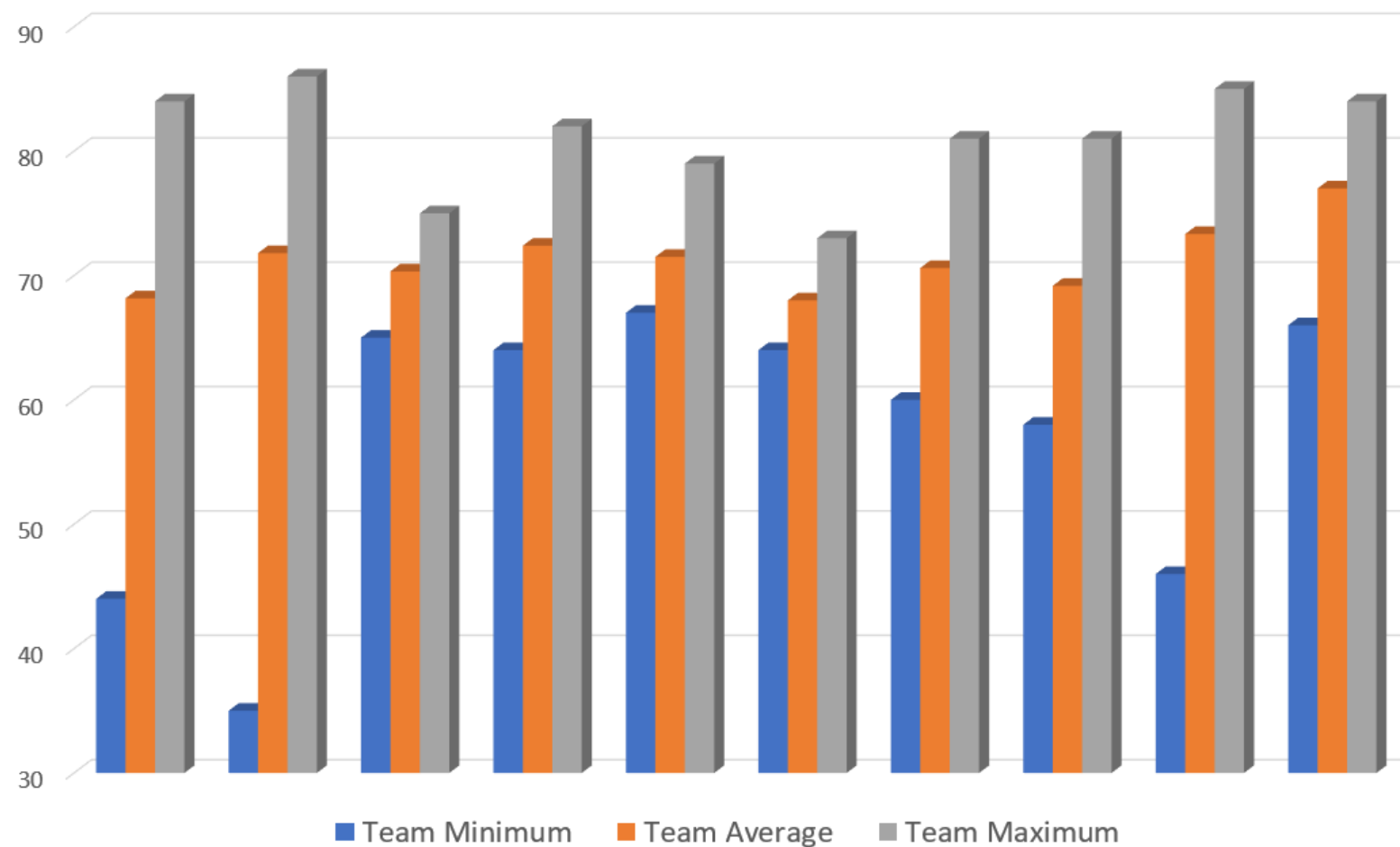
- 2021-2022:
 - 289 students
 - 7 manual adjustments
 - 4 were borderline marks
- 2020-2021
 - 225 students
 - 28 manual adjustments
 - 21 were borderline marks





Assessment - Scaling

Marks Distributions within Teams





- **Start writing your CVs** as soon as possible:
 - An example CV is available on Moodle
 - Peer review each other's CVs
 - CVs are marked (4% of total mark)
- Give **your consent to share your CV** with the sponsor (Moodle)
 - Your choice **does not influence your mark**
 - Inform your **group administrator** to not include your CV



- **Start drafting your Eols** after successful registration
 - An additional **Eol lecture** will be given next week
 - **All expressions of interest and pitches will be marked**
 - Do not try to game the system
- **Further information to follow next week**



- **In person meetings?**
 - Lab slots on Fridays, 11:00 – 13:00:
 - No other teaching activities assigned in this time
 - I will catch up with individual teams from time to time
- **Will I be able to contribute enough to the team?**
 - Lots of different roles, enabling everyone to contribute
- **Will I be dependent on other team members for my marks?**
 - Group marks are scaled based on contribution
 - Individual marks are not influence by team members



Questions?